

1. Datasette Agent

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-21T19:52:19+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/21/datasette-agent/#atom-everything>

We just announced the first release of Datasette Agent , a new extensible AI assistant for Datasette. I've been working on my LLM Python library for just over three years now, and Datasette Agent represents the moment that LLM and Datasette finally come together. I'm really excited about it! Datasette Agent provides a conversational interface for asking questions of the data you have stored in Datasette. Add the datasette-agent-charts plugin and it can generate charts of your data as well. The demo The announcement post (on the new Datasette project blog) includes this demo video : I recorded the video against the new agent.datasette.io live demo instance, which runs Datasette Agent against example databases including the classic global-power-plants by WRI , and a copy of the Datasette backup of my blog. The live demo runs on Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite - it's cheap, fast and has no trouble writing SQLite queries. A question I asked in the demo was: when did Simon most recently see a pelican? Which ran this SQL query : `SELECT title, commentary, created FROM blog_beat WHERE beat_type = 'sighting ' AND (title LIKE ' %pelican% ' OR commentary LIKE ' %pelican% ' ) ORDER BY created DESC LIM...`

2. datasette-agent-sprites 0.1a0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-21T18:21:07+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/21/datasette-agent-sprites/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-agent-sprites 0.1a0 A Datasette Agent plugin for running commands in a Fly Sprites sandbox. Tags: sandboxing , datasette , fly , datasette-agent

3. datasette-agent-charts 0.1a2

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-21T15:15:58+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/21/datasette-agent-charts/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-agent-charts 0.1a2 "View SQL query" buttons below rendered charts. Tags: datasette , datasette-agent

4. Alleged Kimwolf Botmaster ?Dort? Arrested, Charged in U.S. and Canada

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 21:50:25 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/05/alleged-kimwolf-botmaster-dort-arrested-charged-in-u-s-and-canada/>

Canadian authorities on Wednesday arrested a 23-year-old Ottawa man on suspicion of building and operating Kimwolf, a fast spreading Internet-of-Things botnet that enslaved millions of devices for use in a series of massive distributed denial-of-service (DDoS) attacks over the past six months. KrebsOnSecurity publicly named the suspect in February 2026 after the accused launched a volley of DDoS, doxing and swatting campaigns against this author and a security researcher. He now faces criminal hacking charges in both Canada and the United States.

5. The famous o3 "GeoGuessr" prompt did not work

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/the-o3-geoguessr-prompt-did-not-work/>

In April last year, Kelsey Piper discovered that OpenAI's o3 model was surprisingly good at figuring out where a photo was taken from. Like human ?geoguessr? pros , o3 could sometimes take a nondescript photo of a beach and tell you exactly where it is. Here?s the example Kelsey gave: Several people reproduced this with good results: not a 100% success rate, but clearly far better than you'd do with a random human guess. The lesson here is that model capabilities can surprise us . The o3 model had been released for two weeks before Kelsey?s tweet without anyone noticing how good it was at geolocation. What obscure capabilities did we never find? What capabilities of current models are we missing today? Some people drew another lesson from

this: that ?prompt engineering? can unlock brand-new capabilities. This is because Kelsey had a magic prompt that she built over time. When o3 got something wrong, she would ask it how it could have avoided the mistake, and then included that in the prompt. Here?s the first 10% of that prompt, so you get the idea: You are playing a one-round game of GeoGuessr. Your task: from a single still image, infer the most likely real-world location. Note t...

6. Apple Seeks Supreme Court Review of Contempt Finding and Injunction Scope in Epic Games Case

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-22T01:00:47Z

Link: <https://9to5mac.com/2026/05/21/apple-seeks-supreme-court-review-of-contempt-finding-and-injunction-scope-in-epic-games-case/>

Marcus Mendes, reporting for 9to5Mac: Apple today filed a request with the Supreme Court in an attempt to reverse key lower court rulings over the App Store injunction in its long-running legal battle with Epic Games. [...] In its petition, Apple is asking the Supreme Court to review two questions. The first is whether Apple should have been held in contempt for charging a commission on purchases made outside the App Store. The second is about the scope of the injunction. On the first point, Apple argues that the original injunction did not specifically address commissions. Instead, it says the order only prevented Apple from blocking developers from including buttons, external links, or other calls to action directing users to external purchasing options. According to Apple, that is not the same as saying the company could not charge a commission on those purchases. The Ninth Circuit acknowledged that the text of the injunction did not address commissions, but still upheld the contempt finding by relying on the idea that a party can violate the ?spirit? of an injunction, even when the injunction does not specifically prohibit the conduct at issue. Apple?s argument here is that on...

7. Apple TV to Broadcast Entire MLS Match Shot Using iPhones

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-21T23:59:07Z

Link: <https://www.apple.com/newsroom/2026/05/apple-tv-to-air-first-major-live-pro-sports-event-shot-on-iphone-17-pro/>

Speaking of Apple and sports, here?s another one from Apple Newsroom: This Saturday, May 23, Apple TV will present a special live Major League Soccer match captured exclusively on iPhone 17 Pro ? marking the first time iPhone will be used to capture the entirety of a major professional live sporting event broadcast. Developed in partnership with MLS, the milestone broadcast will feature the LA Galaxy vs. Houston Dynamo FC, streaming live on Apple TV from Dignity Health Sports Park in Carson, California, during the final weekend of MLS play before the regular season pauses for the FIFA World Cup 2026 in North America. The word ?major? is doing a bit of work in the phrase ?major professional live sporting event? here, but it?s still quite a moment for iPhone photography. Apple started using iPhone 17 Pro cameras during Friday Night Baseball games last year , but this will be the first event to use them exclusively. ?

8. Apple Sports Expands to More Than 90 New Countries on Cusp of World Cup

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-21T19:13:56Z

Link: <https://www.apple.com/newsroom/2026/05/apple-sports-expands-to-more-than-90-new-countries-and-regions/>

Apple Newsroom: Apple Sports ? the free app for iPhone that gives fans access to real-time scores, stats, and more ? is now available to download on the App Store in more than 170 countries and regions around the world, including more than 90 newly added markets. Designed for speed and simplicity, the app delivers a personalized experience, putting fans? favorite teams and leagues front and center with a simple, intuitive interface designed by Apple. Apple Sports is helping fans get ready for the World Cup by allowing them to explore tournament groupings and customize their scoreboards simply by following the entire tournament or their favorite national teams ? making it easier to stay on top of key moments when the tournament kicks off in June. Following a team also enables Live Activities on a user?s iPhone Lock Screen or Apple Watch, letting them follow every moment of a match with just a quick glance. I?ve got some gripes about certain specific aspects of Apple Sports. Like, where does one even start to

explain how much is wrong with their zero-sum visualization of team stats ? Has anyone ever even seen a presentation like that before? Anyone ? But overall it really is a good...

9. The classic TreeView control lets me sort by name or by IParam, but why not both?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 20 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260520-00/?p=112343>

You need to arrange to get one from the other. The post The classic TreeView control lets me sort by name or by IParam, but why not both? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

10. Notes on respectfully getting a personal copy of a website's contents

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-21T22:46:35Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/web/RespectfulPersonalArchiving>

Suppose, hypothetically, that you want to have a personal copy of the content of some website that you feel is important (to you). There are perfectly good reasons to want such a copy; websites go away all the time on the Internet, and not everyone is online all of the time. It's generally possible to do this (and it's certainly possible to do this with Wandering Thoughts), but there's some things the hypothetical you is going to more or less need to do. These things will be work, but that's the difference between successfully getting a personal copy and turning a brute force crawler lose and then getting ratelimited and blocked. It's also the difference between being polite and being rude , and hopefully you care about that. (With the increasing decay of Internet search engines, you might also want to build your own personal index of useful website content.) First, you need to work out the URLs for the real content of the website. Many websites of interest have some mixture of real pages and various sorts of indexes and other aggregations of those real pages, and it's not uncommon for the index pages to outnumber the real pages , sometimes vastly. Your personal copy of the websi...

11. Unix has been changing, but in places where I don't see it

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-21T01:58:32Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/unix/UnixChangingQuietly>

For reasons beyond the scope of this entry , I've wound up thinking about how stable or unstable the Unix landscape has been 'recently' (which means for more than a decade, and especially as compared with the 1990s and early 00s). I've written about aspects of this before, such as the fading out of multi-architecture Unix environments . In thinking about it more after my Fediverse post, I've come to feel that the Unix environment has still been changing but in places where I'm not as conscious of it. The biggest change is probably the growth of cloud Unix, which I could characterize as "Unix machines on demand". In practice, cloud Unix is a whole new Unix environment that is quite different from traditional Unix, with different tools and especially different practices. Some of the practices are (sort of) extensions from old fashioned large scale Unix administration but many aren't really. I'm aware of cloud Unix and this gulf between operating it and what we do if I think about it, but I don't usually. Cloud Unix practices spill over into what people want to do outside of the cloud, in the form of things like containers. Operating software through containers is quite different fro...

12. Couth and uncouth function pairs

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 17:31:13 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/21/couth-and-uncouth-function-pairs/>

?You can?t always get what you want. But sometimes you get what you need.? ? The Rolling Stones Circular functions and hyperbolic functions aren?t invertible, but we invert them anyway. These functions map many points in the domain to each point in the range, and we invert them by mapping a point in the range [?] The post Couth and uncouth function pairs first appeared on John D. Cook .

13. Circular and hyperbolic functions differ by rotations

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 15:53:56 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/21/circular-hyperbolic-rotations/>

The difference between a circular function and a hyperbolic function is a rotation or two. For example, $\cosh(z) = \cos(iz)$. You can read that as saying that to find the hyperbolic cosine of z , first you rotate z a quarter turn to the left (i.e. multiply by i) and then take the cosine. For another example, [?] The post Circular and hyperbolic functions differ by rotations first appeared on John D. Cook .

14. "No way to prevent this" say users of only package manager where this regularly happens

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://xeiaso.net/shitposts/no-way-to-prevent-this/supply-chain/2026-art-template/>

In the hours following the news that art-template fell victim to a supply chain attack via NPM, developers and systems administrators scrambled ensure all of their projects were unaffected from a supply chain attack where attackers have controlled the repository since 2025 and are using it to load unauthorized JavaScript from third party domains, including but not limited to Baidu Analytics. This is due to the affected dependencies being distributed via NPM , the only package manager where these supply-chain attacks regularly happen. "This was a terrible tragedy, but sometimes these things just happen and there's nothing anyone can do to stop them," said programmer Mrs. Macy Von, echoing statements expressed by hundreds of thousands of programmers who use the only package manager where 90% of the world's supply-chain attacks have occurred in the last decade, and whose projects are 20 times more likely to fall victim to supply chain attacks. "It's a shame, but what can we do? There really isn't anything we can do to prevent supply-chain attacks from happening if the maintainers don't want to secure access to their accounts in a robust manner". At press time, users of the only pa...

15. "No way to prevent this" say users of only language where this regularly happens

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://xeiaso.net/shitposts/no-way-to-prevent-this/CVE-2026-45250/>

In the hours following the release of CVE-2026-45250 for the project FreeBSD , site reliability workers and systems administrators scrambled to desperately rebuild and patch all their systems to fix a kernel stack overflow when validating permissions of the setcred(2) system call, allowing arbitrary code execution in the context of the kernel. This is due to the affected components being written in C, the only programming language where these vulnerabilities regularly happen. "This was a terrible tragedy, but sometimes these things just happen and there's nothing anyone can do to stop them," said programmer Mrs. Gregoria Doyle, echoing statements expressed by hundreds of thousands of programmers who use the only language where 90% of the world's memory safety vulnerabilities have occurred in the last 50 years, and whose projects are 20 times more likely to have security vulnerabilities. "It's a shame, but what can we do? There really isn't anything we can do to prevent memory safety vulnerabilities from happening if the programmer doesn't want to write their code in a robust manner." At press time, users of the only programming language in the world where these vulnerabilities reg...

16. Whale Fall

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 11:34:15 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/05/whale-fall/>

Somewhere, in the endless blue ocean, a gigantic mammal shudders as it takes its last breath. Thanks to science, we know that all dogs go to heaven, but all whales descend through the murky depths until their carcasses litter the seabed. Imagine a giant dying. You can't. They are huge and endless. A towering presence which, so it seems, has always been part of our world. They dominate and are?

17. TIL: Symlinking NixOS Dotfiles

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-05-21T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/05/21/symlinking-nixos-dotfiles.html>

The standard answer to managing dotfiles on NixOS is home-manager. I've never used it, due to

two aesthetic and one practical objection:

18. NGC 4236

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Tue, 12 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://maurycyz.com/astro/ngc4236/>

North is left, mirrored. 0.33 arcsec/pixel (16' by 11') Total exposure time : 457 * 30 seconds = 3.8 hours. Exposure used in stack : 187 * 30 seconds = 1.5 hours. Telescope : C9.25 (230mm aperture, f/10, fl=2300mm) Camera : IMX533 (16 mm diagonal, square, OSC) Processing : (no software sharpening used) Calibration stacking (average w/ rejection) White balance and blackground subtraction Asinh stretch Light denoising Tone curve Crop There's not too much to say about this: it's barred spiral galaxy with uneven arms. Because of it's fairly low surface brightness (as galaxies go), the image uses data collected across nights. However, it's still not very much because of the vanishingly small amount of darkness this time of year, and because I forgot the dew shield on during the second night. However, there is a nearby galaxy cluster at 12h15m37s +69°32'30": I don't think this has any names or catalog designations. Hubble hasn't imaged it, so the best references available are ground-based sky surveys. Raw stacks: 32-bits compressed.

19. RFC: Artificial Contributors to Open Source

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-21T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/21/rfc-artificial-contributors-to-open-source.html>

Open Source Working Group A. Nesbitt Internet-Draft Independent Intended status: Best Current Practice 21 May 2026 Expires: 22 November 2026 Abstract This document specifies disclosure, quality, and behavioural requirements for non-human contributors to open source software projects. Distribution of this memo is unlimited. 1. Introduction Open source projects increasingly receive contributions whose authorship is undeclared and whose volume exceeds the project's review capacity. Existing contribution guidelines were written on the assumption that the contributor could experience embarrassment. This document updates that guidance for cases where the assumption does not hold. 2. Terminology The key words ?MUST?, ?MUST NOT?, ?SHOULD?, ?SHOULD NOT?, and ?MAY? in this document are to be interpreted as described in BCP 14 [RFC2119] [RFC8174] when, and only when, they appear in all capitals as shown here. Artificial Contributor (AC) : A system that produces contributions to a software project other than by direct human authorship, or a human submitting the output of such a system without having read it. Operator : The human, if any, on whose behalf an AC acts and in whose name its co...

20. The Rise of Build-to-Rent Housing

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 12:03:24 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/the-rise-of-build-to-rent-housing>

A major shift in the housing market in the last several years is the rapidly increasing popularity of ?build-to-rent? homes ? single-family homes that are built specifically for the purpose of being rented out.

21. Anthropic's "Profitability" Swindle

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 17:08:19 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/anthropics-profitability-swindle/>

Yesterday, the Wall Street Journal ran a story about how Anthropic is ?about to have its first profitable quarter,? specifically an operating profit, or EBITDA profitability: Anthropic's revenue is set to more than double to \$10.9 billion in the second quarter, an explosive rate of

22. Book Notes: ?Poor Charlie?s Almanack?

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/book-notes-charlie-munger/>

I've been slowly listening to Poor Charlie?s Almanack: The Essential Wit and Wisdom of Charles T. Munger . I like his practicality. He?s never trying to be overly academic, as if he needs to prove how smart he is. He says Berkshire?s success doesn?t come from them solving hard

problems, but from spending their time knowing what a simple solution looks like ? and acting on it when they see it! We've succeeded by making the world easy for us, not by solving the world's hard problems. Munger analogizes their approach to investing like jumping a fence. They don't spend all their time trying to figure out how to jump a seven-foot tall fence. Instead, they find a spot where the fence is only a foot tall, jump it, and take the reward on the other side. The approach he articulates for investing, in fact, seems broadly applicable to any kind of problem solving: Quickly eliminate the universe of what not to do. Follow up with a multi-disciplinary attack on what remains. Act decisively when ? and only when ? the right circumstances appear. Whenever people ask him for advice (as if somehow he could bestow upon them some kind of knowledge that will save them the pain and hardship of experience...

23. The stock market returns 4 %

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/stock-market-returns-4-percent>

People assume all sorts of wild stock market returns when they make their financial calculations. Here are some numbers that show up on web searches: 6 % 8.4 % 10 % 10.1 % 11.3 % 11.5 % 13.6 % 16 % These are all correctly computed under their respective assumptions, but they are very misleading because whatever those assumptions were, they're not relevant for most calculations. You should assume 4 % in your calculations. Here's one way to arrive at that: The S&P 500 has historically yielded 12 % per year before inflation. But that's the arithmetic mean. Returns compound geometrically, so what we actually want is the compound annual growth rate . The typical rule of thumb is to remove half the squared volatility from the arithmetic mean. Volatility is notoriously hard to estimate, but let's put it at 15%30 %. This leaves us with a CAGR of 8%11 % . During the same period, inflation has been 3%4 % depending on which source you trust. This brings the real (inflation-adjusted) returns down to 4%8 % . On top of that, we have holding costs, transaction costs (e.g. rebalancing), and taxes. These are different in different localities and vary by investment strategy, but let's say they remo...

24. The \$500 Price Increase

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-05-21T15:03:44Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17345764/plex-price-increase-self-hosting>

Plex sends a message to the self-hosting community with a massive upcharge targeted at the very people who hate monthly fees.

25. Magic the Gathering format: Fun 40

Source: Fabien Sanglard | Published: 20 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://fabiansanglard.net/mtg/fun//index.html>

(No summary)

26. Pluralistic: Shopping isn't politics (21 May 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 15:03:37 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/05/21/purity-culture/>

Today's links Shopping isn't politics: The personal isn't political. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Neither arphid nor RFID; Gor novel sex slave cult; Violent economist sex criminals; Vade et caca in pilleum et ipse traheatur super aures tuo; "We Stand on Guard"; Healthy FLOSS; Lawsuits 2.0; CDC v zombie apocalypse; Gandhi's speeches; Apple v games about Palestine; Second Life chuds v Bernie; UK was never a "white" country; Dead, broke; Who Broke the Internet? (III) Upcoming appearances: Hay-on-Wye, London, Kansas City, LA, Menlo Park, Toronto, NYC, Edinburgh. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Shopping isn't politics (permalink) I've written before about the futility of "voting with your wallet." Billionaires love it when you try to vote with your wallet, because while billionaires only represent 0.00004% of the population, their wallets are 100,000 times larger than average, which means that when we vote with wallets, a billionaire's

vote counts 100,000 times more than yours: <https://pluralistic.net/2025/09/13/consum...>

27. Digitale autonomie: wat kunnen organisaties NU doen

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 13:30:00 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/digitale-autonomie-wat-kunnen-organisaties-nu-doen/>

De zorgen over digitale autonomie nemen toe, en steeds vaker krijg ik van (grote) organisaties de vraag: wat kunnen we NU doen? Nou heb ik wel een lijstje, maar voor we beginnen, besef dat we 15 jaar lang alles naar Amerika hebben geschoffeld. Of, we hebben het uitbesteed, en DIE mensen stuurden het naar Amerika. 15 jaar is een lange tijd, en we zijn niet 1 2 3 weer ?in vorm? om de zaken weer anders aan te pakken.

28. Tracing App Thoughts and Links

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 11 Apr 2020 13:46:27 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/tracing-app-thoughts-and-links/>

As many countries are now managing to drive down their COVID-19 epidemic, thoughts are turning to how to manage the outbreak beyond the ?lockdown?. The restrictions we live under now do appear to work, but for multiple reasons, they?ll be hard to maintain. When the epidemic was small, it was possible to trace every new infection and isolate potential new cases. This did buy time, but for most countries, ?the cat was out the bag already?.

29. Corona Updates: hoopgevende ontwikkelingen realistisch bekeken

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Mon, 06 Apr 2020 13:31:55 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/de-dagelijkse-corona-update/>

Ik heb op Facebook beloofd iedere dag een "Corona Update" te sturen met ontwikkelingen die hoopgevend zijn, terwijl ik het wel realistisch houd. Hier verzamel ik de updates zodat ze ook buiten Facebook te bekijken zijn. Er is genoeg nieuws om je zorgen over te maken dat ik het nodig vind ook dingen die kunnen helpen te belichten. Mensen die me kennen weten dat ik geen optimist ben, het is geen ?goed nieuws show? hier.